Abhinav Ramaswamy

PhD Candidate, Stanford University
Department of Political Science
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Research Interests: Congress, Political Communication, Statistical Methods

Education

Stanford University 2022 – 2027 (expected)
Ph.D. in Political Science
Subfields: American Politics and Political Methodology
Dissertation Committee: Justin Grimmer (chair), Avidit Acharya, Gary Cox

Stanford University 2025 – 2026
M.S. in Statistics

Georgetown University 2018 – 2022
B.S. in Foreign Service (with honors), *Cum Laude*

Working Papers

3. **Donor Networks and the Incentive to Defect in Congress.** [link to paper]
Presented at the 2024 Annual Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology (Poster), 2025 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting, and 2025 Stanford-Vienna Joint Conference on Polarization and Parties.

2. **Does User Engagement Shape Congressional Candidates' Issue Agendas on Twitter?** (with Michael A. Bailey) *Revise and Resubmit* [link to paper]
Presented at the 2023 Western Political Science Association Meeting.

1. **An Evaluation of Fraud Claims from the 2020 Trump Election Contests.** (with Justin Grimmer) [link to paper]
Coverage: Not Another Politics Podcast, Cato Institute

Works in Progress

3. **Phantom Pre-Trends and Dynamic Effects in Event-Studies with Imbalanced Panels** (with Nico Studen)
Presented poster at the 2026 Annual Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology

2. **The Prevalence and Effects of Interpretive Campaign Coverage: Evidence from U.S. Television News from 1968-2024** (with Shanto Iyengar)
Presented at the 2026 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting.

1. **Reinforcement Learning: Do Politicians Optimize for Engagement on Twitter?**
Presented poster at the 2025 Annual Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology and paper at the 2025 American Political Science Association Annual Meeting.

Conference Presentations

Annual Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology (Poster)	2024, 2025, 2026
American Political Science Association Annual Meeting	2025, 2026
Stanford-Vienna Joint Conference on Polarization and Parties	2025
Western Political Science Association Annual Meeting	2023
Georgetown Massive Data Institute Scholars Showcase	2021, 2022

Professional Membership and Service

American Political Science Association (APSA), *Member*
Society for Political Methodology, *Member*

APSA Panel on "Political Campaigns and Advertising", *Chair and Discussant*	2025
APSA Panel on "Candidate Rhetoric and Persuasion Strategy", *Chair and Discussant*	2026

Teaching

Stanford University, Teaching Assistant

American Politics and Policy: In Defense of Democracy	Spring 2026
Political Methodology II: Causal Inference (Graduate-Level)	Winter 2025
The American West	Spring 2025
Controversies in American Public Policy	Winter 2024
Political Methodology I: Regression (Graduate-Level)	Fall 2024

Awards and Fellowships

Hoover Institution Center for Revitalizing American Institutions Seed Grant ($24,800)	2026
George P. Shultz Dissertation Fund ($1,400)	2024
Fritz Family Fellowship: Georgetown Initiative on Tech & Society (Georgetown University)	2022
Massive Data Institute Scholar (Georgetown University)	2020–2022

Additional Research Experience

Research Assistant, Georgetown University: Massive Data Institute — 2020 – 2022
PI: Michael A. Bailey

Research Assistant, Georgetown University: Institute for the Study of Migration — 2020–2021
PI: Elizabeth Ferris

Research Assistant, Ohio State University: Department of Political Science — 2017–2018
PI: Brice Acree

Skills

Programming: R, LaTeX
Languages: English (native), Chinese (working proficiency)